MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM MGU-UGP (HONOURS) FOURTH SEMESTER EXAMINATION (2024 ADMISION ONWARDS)

MG4DSEHIS202 Field Techniques in Archaeology

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

PART A – Multiple Choice Questions

(Answer any TEN questions. Each question carries 1 mark.)

1. The primary purpose of a literature survey in archaeology is to [U] [CO1]
   a) Identify excavation tools
   b) Review previous studies and findings
   c) Classify artefacts
   d) Date archaeological sites

2. Which map is most useful for understanding elevation and terrain? [U] [CO1]
   a) Political map
   b) Thematic map
   c) Topographical map
   d) Cadastral map

3. Foot survey in archaeology mainly involves [A] [CO1]
   a) Aerial photography
   b) Walking systematically to locate surface remains
   c) Subsurface excavation
   d) Laboratory analysis

4. GIS in archaeology is primarily used for [Ap] [CO2]
   a) Artefact dating
   b) Spatial data management and analysis
   c) Carbon estimation
   d) Pottery drawing

5. Which method measures subsurface resistance to electric current? [U] [CO2]
   a) Magnetic survey
   b) Resistivity survey
   c) Aerial survey
   d) Probe survey

6. Establishing a datum point is associated with [A] [CO3]
   a) Exploration
   b) Excavation
   c) Dating
   d) Conservation

7. Vertical excavation mainly helps in understanding [A] [CO3]
   a) Site layout
   b) Stratigraphic sequence
   c) Artefact distribution
   d) Landscape pattern

8. Harris Matrix is related to [An] [CO4]
   a) Typology
   b) Stratigraphic interpretation
   c) Radiocarbon dating
   d) Seriation

9. Typology is a method of [An] [CO5]
   a) Absolute dating
   b) Relative dating
   c) Chemical dating
   d) Physical dating

10. Dendrochronology is based on [E] [CO5]
    a) Tree-ring analysis
    b) Soil layers
    c) Pottery firing temperature
    d) Stone tool morphology

PART B – Short Answer Questions

Answer any FIVE questions. Each answer should not exceed 50 words.
(5 out of 8 × 2 = 10 marks)

13. Define manual methods of archaeological exploration [U] [CO1]

14. What is map reading and why is it important in archaeological fieldwork? [U] [CO1]

15. Mention any two advantages of village-to-village survey. [A] [CO1]

16. What is resistivity survey? [U] [CO2]

17. What is the role of computer applications in archaeological field survey? [Ap] [CO2]

18. What is a site grid? [A] [CO3]
19. Define stratigraphy in archaeology. [An] [CO4]
20. What is relative dating? [U] [CO5]

PART C – Short Essay Questions

Answer any FOUR questions. Each answer should not exceed 150 words.
(4 out of 7 × 5 = 20 marks)

21. Explain the importance of literature survey and previous excavation reports in archaeological exploration. [U] [CO1]
22. Describe the different kinds of maps used in archaeological fieldwork and their applications. [A] [CO1]
23. Discuss the role of scientific tools such as aerial survey and GIS in archaeological exploration. [Ap] [CO2]
24. Explain the procedures involved in establishing site grid and datum during excavation. [A] [CO3]
25. Describe the principles of stratigraphy and the use of Harris Matrix in archaeological interpretation. [An] [CO4]
26. Explain the importance of archaeological photography in field documentation. [Ap] [CO1, CO2]
27. Discuss relative dating methods with reference to typology and seriation. [An] [CO5]

PART D – Essay Questions

Answer any TWO questions. Each answer should not exceed 450 words.
(2 out of 4 × 15 = 30 marks)

28. Critically evaluate the manual methods of archaeological exploration, highlighting their relevance and limitations in modern archaeological research. [E] [CO1]
29. Explain in detail the scientific tools used in archaeological exploration and assess their role in data retrieval and interpretation. [E] [CO2]
30. Describe the methods of archaeological excavation with special reference to vertical and horizontal excavation and trenching techniques. [E] [CO3]
31. Evaluate the various dating methods used in archaeology, distinguishing between relative and absolute dating with suitable examples. [E] [CO5]